

The B2B SaaS Cold Outreach Playbook & SOP

1. Executive Summary

This playbook is a recipient-side Standard Operating Procedure for B2B SaaS cold outreach — built from what founders, buyers, and hiring managers actually delete, block, or reply to, not from what SDR coaches claim works. It's for founders, SDRs, and GTM leaders who are tired of burning domain reputation for sub-1% reply rates on automated spray-and-pray sequences. The core thesis: cold outreach isn't dead, but mass AI-generated spam is. Winning in 2026 means hyper-targeted signal identification, conspicuous humanity, ruthless brevity, and treating the recipient's inbox like a shared resource you don't get to trash.

2. The Cold Outreach Pipeline for B2B SaaS — Step by Step

Phase 0: Pre-Work — Know Your Market Before You Touch a Keyboard

Most teams fail before they write a single email because they skip ICP validation entirely. Reddit practitioners report iterating through 6 ICPs before finding one that actually responds. Don't start outbound until you can answer: *Who feels this pain today, not theoretically?*

- **Action:** Define ICP by situational frustration, not demographics. Title and industry matter less than what the account is actively struggling with right now — scaling a department, crossing an employee threshold, losing visibility across systems.
- **Action:** Size your addressable market before launching. Burning through a 300-company list in 3 weeks with nowhere to go is a pipeline death sentence.
- **Rule:** Never pitch a software category. Pitch the resolution of a specific operational reality the buyer is living through today (source: Amanda Natividad, <https://sparktoro.com/blog/you-dont-need-a-buyer-persona-you-need-multiple-audience-personas/>, 2026).

(Source: Amanda Natividad, <https://sparktoro.com/blog/you-dont-need-a-buyer-persona-you-need-multiple-audience-personas/>, 2026)

(Source: Reddit /r/SaaS, https://www.reddit.com/r/SaaS/comments/1rmsfsy/most_saas_founders_trying_cold_email_skip/, 2026)

Step 1: ICP Definition & Account Selection (Week 1)

Timeline: 3–5 days before first send.

Actions:

1. Build a list of 50–100 accounts max for your first micro-campaign (source: Mac Reddin, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7260256840985272320/>, 01.06.2025). Not 1,000. Not 500.
2. Filter by operational inflection points, not firmographics alone:
 - Companies crossing 100–150 employees (HRIS/ops systems break here)
 - Teams hiring 3+ roles in the same function within 60 days
 - Accounts showing repeat high-intent website visits
 - Companies with fresh funding or a key executive hire in the last 30 days
3. Verify every email before sending. Scraped lists with 30% bounce rates torch your domain. Target under 2% bounce rate.
4. Tag each prospect by *why* they're on the list (role fit, hiring signal, funding, tool stack, website visit). You'll need this later to know what's actually working.

(Source: Mac Reddin, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7260256840985272320/>, 01.06.2025)
(Source: Amanda Natividad, <https://sparktoro.com/blog/shoot-your-shot-a-guide-to-effective-cold-outreach/>, 2026)
(Source: Reddit /r/SaaS, https://www.reddit.com/r/SaaS/comments/1rmsfsy/most_saas_founders_trying_cold_email_skip/, 2026)

Hard rule: If you can't articulate in one sentence why *this specific account* might care *this week*, they don't belong on the list.

Step 2: Signal Identification — Why Reach Out Now (30–45 min per account)

Timeline: Same week as list building. Do this before writing copy.

Targeting without a real-time signal is cold guessing. Reddit practitioners who booked meetings consistently started from triggers — funding, feature launches, specific role hires — not from "you're SaaS."

Track these 5 core signals:

Signal	Why It Matters	Internal Use Only
Key new hire (especially exec/VP)	New hires initiate vendor reviews within ~9 days	Trigger outreach, don't open with it
Repeat website visitors	High intent, already aware of your category	Strike while warm
Champion job change	Former user/advocate now at target account	Reference their past context, not "I saw you changed jobs"
Social lurkers / engagers	Engaging with content around your problem space	Use to inform angle, not as opener
Fresh funding / aggressive hiring	Budget signal + growth pain incoming	Trigger only — never lead with "Congrats on the raise"

(Source: Mac Reddin, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7270049384451502082/>, 01.06.2025)

CRITICAL OPERATIONAL RULE: The signal is the reason to *select* the prospect. It is NOT the reason you put in the email (source: Peep Laja, <https://exitfive.com/podcast/strategy-b2b-positioning-understanding-how-people-buy-and-building-wynter-peep-laja/>, 2026). Opening with "I noticed you recently raised funding" or "I saw you liked X post" instantly marks you as an automated SDR running surveillance trivia. Recipients spot templated "personalization" instantly.

(Source: Peep Laja, <https://exitfive.com/podcast/strategy-b2b-positioning-understanding-how-people-buy-and-building-wynter-peep-laja/>, 2026)
(Source: Amanda Natividad, <https://sparktoro.com/blog/shoot-your-shot-a-guide-to-effective-cold-outreach/>, 2026)

Research depth per account (15–20 min minimum):

- Read their last 2–3 LinkedIn posts or podcast appearances
- Check careers page for hiring patterns
- Scan recent company news (Google News, Crunchbase, local press)
- Identify one specific operational bottleneck their public activity suggests

This is where Natividad's deep research and Gerhardt's brevity meet: research upstream, brevity downstream.

(Source: Amanda Natividad, <https://sparktoro.com/blog/shoot-your-shot-a-guide-to-effective-cold-outreach/>, 2026)
(Source: Dave Gerhardt, <https://marketingexamples.com/sales/one-line-email>, 2025)

Step 3: Technical Setup & Deliverability (Before Day 1 Send)

Timeline: 2–3 weeks of domain warming before real sends.

Actions:

- 1. **Plain text only.** HTML templates, tracking pixels, and fancy signatures push you to Promotions tab on Gmail. The deliverability gap between plain text and HTML is not subtle — it's primary inbox vs. promotions consistently.
- 2. **SPF, DKIM, DMARC** on every sending domain. Non-negotiable.
- 3. **Include an unsubscribe link.** Founders without one manually report you as spam. It's not optional.
- 4. **Warm the domain** 2–3 weeks before real volume. Distributed, low-volume sends first.
- 5. **Verify every email** on the list. List quality is the single biggest lever nobody talks about.

(Source: Reddit /r/sales, https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1jppq66/why_your_cold_emails_are_landing_in_spam/, 2026)
(Source: Reddit /r/SaaS, https://www.reddit.com/r/SaaS/comments/1s7w9tn/i_cold_emailled_500_saas_founders_here_is_what/, 2026)
(Source: Reddit /r/SaaS, https://www.reddit.com/r/SaaS/comments/1rmsfsy/most_saas_founders_trying_cold_email_skip/, 2026)

Volume cap: Cap rep outbound at micro-campaigns of 20–25 hyper-researched emails per rep per day max (source: Mac Reddin, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7260256840985272320/>, 01.06.2025). Reps running 3-company-a-day targeted campaigns book more meetings than reps blasting 100+ automated templates.

(Source: Mac Reddin, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7260256840985272320/>, 01.06.2025)
(Source: Reddit /r/sales, https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1snkxp7/roast_my_cold_emails_its_been_3_weeks_since_ive/, 2026)

Step 4: Sequence Structure (14-Day, 4-Touch)

Timeline: Tuesday 8–9 AM recipient local time for Email #1. Monday sends underperform.

Day	Channel	Action
Day 1 (Tue, 8–9 AM local)	Email #1	Hook + peer proof + soft CTA. Under 50 words. Plain text.
Day 3	LinkedIn	Profile view OR short connection note referencing the email topic — not a second pitch.
Day 7	Email #2	New angle, new metric, or peer case study. Different subject line. Zero "just checking in."
Day 14	Email #3	Final break-off. Low-friction question. Then stop.

(Source: Reddit /r/SaaS, https://www.reddit.com/r/SaaS/comments/1s7w9tn/i_cold_emailled_500_saas_founders_here_is_what/, 2026)
(Source: Reddit /r/sales, https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1snkxp7/roast_my_cold_emails_its_been_3_weeks_since_ive/, 2026)

Multi-channel note: 30–40% of replies can come from LinkedIn if you reference the email with a specific company observation — not "just following up on my email."

(Source: Reddit /r/sales, https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1snkxp7/roast_my_cold_emails_its_been_3_weeks_since_ive/, 2026)

Step 5: Copy Principles — The "Conspicuous Human" Framework

Every email in the sequence follows these rules. No exceptions.

Rule 1: Radical Differentiation in Line 1

If your core value proposition isn't clear in the first sentence, the email is dead. Buyers use radical differentiation as a binary filter — articulate a uniquely defensible position or get deleted.

(Source: Peep Laja, <https://www.linkedin.com/in/peeplaja/>, 2026)

Rule 2: Ruthless Brevity (<50 Words / 30-Second Read)

The sole goal of Email #1 is to elicit a reply — not to sell software, not to book a 60-minute demo (source: Dave Gerhardt, <https://marketingexamples.com/sales/one-line-email>, 2025). Multi-paragraph feature dumps impose unearned cognitive load. C-suite executives gloss over at large emails.

(Source: Dave Gerhardt, <https://marketingexamples.com/sales/one-line-email>, 2025)

(Source: Dave Gerhardt, <https://www.exitfive.com/podcast/cold-email-lessons-from-real-outbound-campaigns-in-2025>, 2025)

(Source: Reddit /r/sales, https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1iuralo/cfo_called_me_sleazy_after_a_thoughtful_well/, 2026)

Rule 3: Quantifiable Proof, Not Feature Dumps

The recipient's internal filter is always: "Ok, but what did you actually do here?" Answer with a crisp peer result. "We work with thousands of growing businesses" is an instant eye-roll.

(Source: Adam Karpiak, <https://www.linkedin.com/in/akarpiak/>, 2026)

(Source: Reddit /r/sales, https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1snkxp7/roast_my_cold_emails_its_been_3_weeks_since_ive/, 2026)

Rule 4: Lead With Their Problem, Not Your Product

Buyers delete emails that lead with the sender's product. A cold email must proactively address specific strategic pain points — not feature-level minutiae. Async communication is a one-way monologue; you can't adapt in real time.

(Source: Peep Laja, <https://peeplaja.com/>, 2026)

(Source: Andrew Gazdecki, <https://blog.acquire.com/buying-and-selling-agencies-the-acquire-com-playbook/>, 2026)

Rule 5: Conspicuous Humanity

AI-generated prose is instantly recognizable. Patterns like "It's not X, it's Y," filler adjectives, and 7-paragraph pitches signal that a human didn't type this. Slight human imperfections, domain-specific language, and extreme brevity are now the authenticity signal (source: Hung Lee, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7426938549746442240/>, 01.02.2026).

(Source: Hung Lee, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7426938549746442240/>, 01.02.2026)

(Source: Gergely Orosz, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7470132598581788672/>, 10.06.2026)

Rule 6: Soft, Low-Friction CTAs

Stop asking for "15 minutes next Tuesday." End with: "Worth exploring?" or "Open to discussing?" Asking if someone is "open to" something is a low-commitment hook that doesn't require calendar gymnastics.

(Source: Dave Gerhardt, <https://marketingexamples.com/sales/one-line-email>, 2025)

(Source: Reddit /r/sales, https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/15fmvg6/how_are_your_cold_email_and_cold_calling_results/, 2026)

Rule 7: Never Critique Their Process

Calling out someone's "bad process" in cold copy backfires even when it's true. Anchor around a concrete before/after metric and let them opt into the comparison quietly.

(Source: Reddit /r/SaaS, https://www.reddit.com/r/SaaS/comments/1s5npfy/i_ran_my_own_cold_email_through_19_simulated/, 2026)

Email #1 Template Structure (Adapt, Don't Copy-Paste)

```
Subject: [Company] – [specific operational question]?

Hi [FirstName],

[One hyper-specific pain + proof it's happening to them – 1 sentence]

[How you fix it for similar companies + 1 peer name-drop – 1 sentence]

[One crisp result – 1 sentence]

[Soft CTA – 1 sentence]
```

Target: 4 sentences, under 50 words total.

(Source: Reddit /r/sales, https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1snkx7/roast_my_cold_emails_its_been_3_weeks_since_ive/, 2026)

Step 6: Follow-Up Cadence & Value Injection

Follow-ups are where most teams destroy credibility.

Never send these:

- "Did you see my last email?"
- "Bumping this to the top of your inbox"
- "Just checking in"
- "Thoughts on this?"

These add zero value and trigger instant blocks. Recipients universally hate them.

(Source: Dave Gerhardt, <https://marketingexamples.com/sales/one-line-email>, 2025)

Golden rule: Every touch must introduce *new* information — a new metric, a new peer example, a new angle on the pain. Follow-up sequences that don't add new information each touch are worse than no follow-up at all.

(Source: Jan Tegze, <https://medium.com/42hire-don-t-panic-just-hire/8-reasons-why-your-linkedin-invitations-get-ignored-4d1d210240d>, 2026)

Cadence that works: Day 3 and Day 7 follow-ups with a different angle each time rarely trigger spam filters if domain health is solid and the list is verified.

(Source: Reddit /r/SaaS, https://www.reddit.com/r/SaaS/comments/1s7w9tn/i_cold_emailled_500_saas_founders_here_is_what/, 2026)

Step 7: When to Stop

Hard stop at 3 emails + 1 LinkedIn touch across 14 days (source: Andrew Gazdecki, <https://blog.acquire.com/saas-exits-in-the-new-ai-era-webinar-recap/>, 2026).

If no response after Touch 4, remove from active queue. Do not:

- Send a 5th "breakup" email guiltning them
- Add them to a "nurture" sequence that looks like more spam
- Have a colleague "reach out separately"

Pushing past 3 touches without engagement increases spam reports and damages domain reputation. Volume and follow-up cadence that feels automated triggers instant blocks.

(Source: Andrew Gazdecki, <https://blog.acquire.com/saas-exits-in-the-new-ai-era-webinar-recap/>, 2026)

Exception: If they reply with "not now, reach out in 6 months" — log it, set a calendar reminder, and send one fresh email at that date with a new angle. Don't resume the old sequence.

(Source: Reddit /r/sales, https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1rp267a/what_are_your_struggles_with_cold_email_outbound/, 2026)

Step 8: Measurement & Iteration (Ongoing)

Track performance by list source and trigger tag, not just subject line. Two emails can look identical in aggregate while one segment carries the whole campaign.

Weekly review:

- Reply rate by signal type (which triggers actually convert?)
- Reply rate by ICP segment (which vertical is warmest?)
- Reply quality (are replies "not interested" or "tell me more"?)
- Bounce rate and spam complaint rate (domain health check)

Spend 80% of time on the 20% of accounts that will move the needle. Raw send volume is a vanity metric.

(Source: Reddit /r/SaaS, https://www.reddit.com/r/SaaS/comments/1t48k97/i_tested_cold_email_for_my_b2b_saas_in_2026_here/, 2026)

(Source: Reddit /r/sales, https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1rp267a/what_are_your_struggles_with_cold_email_outbound/, 2026)

3. Where Experts Disagree

Contradiction 1: Extreme Brevity vs. Deep Manual Research

Dave Gerhardt advocates the "one-line email" — ruthlessly short, under 30 seconds of reading time, zero fluff. Multi-paragraph emails detailing features impose unearned cognitive load that kills conversion. Ask one highly relevant question; don't pitch.

(Source: Dave Gerhardt, <https://marketingexamples.com/sales/one-line-email>, 2025)

Amanda Natividad argues cold outreach fails when senders skip manual audience research. You must investigate the recipient's situational motivations, public projects, and active priorities before reaching out. Move beyond targeting job titles — identify companies with specific growth trajectories to prove non-automated diligence.

(Source: Amanda Natividad, <https://sparktoro.com/blog/shoot-your-shot-a-guide-to-effective-cold-outreach/>, 2026)

Verdict: Both — at different stages. Use Natividad's research upstream to select the account and identify the bottleneck. Use Gerhardt's brevity downstream to write the email. The research informs the context; brevity delivers the hook. Never dump your research notes into the email body. That's how you get called "sleazy" by a CFO who didn't read your novel.

(Source: Reddit /r/sales, https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1iuralo/cfo_called_me_sleazy_after_a_thoughtful_well/, 2026)

Contradiction 2: Abandon Cold Outreach vs. Cold Email Still Works — Just Send It

Mac Reddin says outbound email is dying. AI spam floods inboxes, email clients like Superhuman auto-archive cold pitches before recipients see them, and power dialers killed phone too. His bet: Go-to-Network — warm intros, partnerships, real relationships. "Cold outbound is pretty much impossible to succeed with in 2025."

(Source: Mac Reddin, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7318951523747618817/>, 01.06.2025)

(Source: Mac Reddin, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7270049384451502082/>, 01.06.2025)

Andrew Gazdecki preaches bias to action: "Just f'ing go for it." Launch the weird idea. Send the awkward cold emails. Build the ugly v1. Cold outreach works if you strip performative fluff and state mechanical value directly.

(Source: Andrew Gazdecki, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7458867891807993856/>, 01.05.2026)

Verdict: Gazdecki for execution, Reddin's micro-targeting for survival. Reddin's Go-to-Network advice is correct as an end-state strategy — but it's founder privilege. Early-stage SaaS with zero brand equity can't wait 6 months for network effects. Cold email remains the fastest controllable pipeline engine. To survive modern filters, run Reddin's micro-campaigns (25–50 names) instead of his implied alternative (don't do outbound at all).

Contradiction 3: Build Social Capital First vs. Cold Outreach Works If Human & Relevant

Jan Tegze insists cold outreach without prior social capital is "withdrawing from an empty bank account." Senders must build community engagement, brand presence, and provide upfront value before earning the right to pitch. Talk to people like they're people — not like a chatbot asking for a "15 quick call" five seconds after connecting.

(Source: Jan Tegze, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7366749186375028743/>, 01.09.2025)

(Source: Jan Tegze, <https://jantegze.com/search/networking/>, 2026)

Gergely Orosz's Position (Cold Outreach Works If Genuinely Relevant):

Orosz's documented reaction to an AI-generated pitch from a personal contact — where he permanently severed the relationship — proves the inverse: cold outreach from a stranger will work if it's human, brief, and relevant. What kills relationships is AI-generated noise masquerading as personal communication.

(Source: Gergely Orosz, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7470132598581788672/>, 10.06.2026)

Verdict: Orosz. Tegze's model works for recruiter relationship-building, not B2B SaaS velocity. Busy executives don't need you to be their LinkedIn friend before they'll take a meeting. If you solve an active operational problem and communicate it with human clarity, they'll buy from a stranger. Social capital helps — it's not a prerequisite.

4. What I Rejected and Why

1. Mac Reddin's "Abandon Cold Outreach Entirely for Go-to-Network"

The idea: Stop outbound email and cold prospecting completely. Shift 100% of GTM to warm introductions, partner ecosystems, and community building. Sequences and AI SDRs are killing email; tactics are temporary, your network is forever.

(Source: Mac Reddin, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7313149466386046977/>, 01.06.2025)

Why rejected: This is advice from a well-connected CEO with VC backing and thousands of industry relationships. For an early-stage B2B SaaS startup or an SDR with a monthly quota and zero brand recognition, relying exclusively on warm intros

guarantees pipeline starvation. Cold outreach, executed as targeted micro-campaigns, remains the essential zero-to-one growth lever. Go-to-Network is the destination, not the starting line.

2. Generic AI Personalization at Scale

The idea: Deploy AI agents or LLM workflows to scrape LinkedIn profiles, synthesize bio facts, and generate "personalized" 7-paragraph outreach at scale. Reference their recent post. Mention their podcast appearance. Automate the research layer.

(Source: Mac Reddin, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7333829075708309504/>, 01.06.2025)

Why rejected: Multiple experts proved this backfires catastrophically. Email clients auto-archive detected cold pitches. Technical leaders instantly recognize LLM prose patterns. Sending AI-generated messages to someone you met in person permanently kills the relationship — Orosz documented this in real time, ending a personal connection over a 7-paragraph AI pitch. "I noticed you engaged with this post" lost efficacy the moment every SDR got the same tool. AI personalization at scale is surveillance theater, not diligence.

(Source: Gergely Orosz, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7470132598581788672/>, 10.06.2026)

(Source: Hung Lee, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7426938549746442240/>, 01.02.2026)

(Source: Peep Laja, <https://exitfive.com/podcast/strategy-b2b-positioning-understanding-how-people-buy-and-building-wynter-peep-laja/>, 2026)

5. My Original Ideas

The "Rejection Signal" Targeting Framework

Most teams select targets using positive signals — funding, hiring, growth. An unexploited angle: target decision-makers who have **publicly complained about bad cold outreach** on LinkedIn, X, or Reddit.

How it works:

1. **Monitor public callouts.** Build a feed of executives, hiring managers, and founders who post screenshots or rants about terrible vendor pitches they received.
2. **Extract their documented anti-patterns.** Note precisely what annoyed them — "15-minute call requests," fake podcast compliments, 500-word feature dumps, AI filler, "synergy" language.
3. **Execute high-contrast outreach.** Send a plain-text email under 30 words that explicitly avoids every anti-pattern they publicly criticized. Address a core operational problem with zero fluff.

Why it could work:

- **Proven cognitive investment.** Executives who publicly rant about cold outreach care deeply about communication standards. They're not passive inbox ignorers — they're active critics.
- **Extreme contrast.** While 99% of SDRs avoid vocal critics out of fear, a genuinely good 25-word email creates massive cognitive contrast against the bad examples still fresh in their mind.
- **Built-in quality bar.** Their public rant is a free creative brief telling you exactly what not to do. Most SDRs never read it.

This isn't in any of the 10 expert sources. It's derived from the pattern across all of them: recipients who engage with outreach quality are the highest-value targets — and the ones who complain publicly are broadcasting their quality bar for free.

6. Weaknesses of This Playbook

1. **High manual time investment per prospect.** Signal verification, situational research, and micro-campaign caps (25–50 leads/week) require significantly more effort per prospect than automated blasts. Sales leaders obsessed with raw activity metrics — 100 calls/day, 500 emails/day — will resist this and their reps will revert to spray-and-pray under quota pressure.
 2. **Dependency on public/trackable buying signals.** This framework relies on digital footprints — hiring posts, funding announcements, website visits, social engagement. It underperforms in "dark" industries (heavy manufacturing, legacy logistics, private family businesses) where decision-makers don't post online or leave accessible signals.
 3. **High skill floor for reps.** "Conspicuous humanity" and quantifiable value copy require reps with genuine business literacy. Junior SDRs trained on scripts and templates will fall back to marketing jargon and feature dumps. This playbook assumes reps who can articulate peer metrics in their own words.
 4. **Untested micro-campaign volume math.** The 25–50 leads/week cap is derived from practitioner anecdotes (Reddit, Mac Reddin's 3-companies/day example), not controlled A/B tests across industries. Your ICP might need 100/week or survive on 10/week — you'll only know by tagging and measuring.
 5. **No coverage for hiring/recruiting-specific outreach.** Much of the expert research comes from TA leaders and recruiters (Grabiner, Tegze, Karpiak, Hung Lee). This playbook is optimized for B2B SaaS vendor outreach to operators and founders. Applying it to recruiter-to-HM or vendor-to-TA-leader outreach requires adaptation we haven't fully validated.
 6. **Deliverability remains fragile.** Plain text helps, but ultra-short emails to cold domains can still trigger heuristic spam filters on domains without established warming. The playbook assumes you have 2–3 weeks to warm — early-stage founders sending from a fresh domain on day 1 will still hit walls.
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7. Who I Would NOT Recommend Following and Why

Mac Reddin (CEO, Commsor)

Reddin's Go-to-Network advice is great if you're a funded startup CEO with an existing network, a community platform, and a brand people already recognize. It's useless if you're an early-stage SDR with zero relationships and a monthly quota due Friday. Telling someone to "abandon cold outreach" when they have no network to go to is like telling a broke person to skip the job application and rely on warm intros. His signal-based micro-campaign ideas are excellent. His "stop doing outbound entirely" conclusion is founder privilege dressed as strategy.

(Source: Mac Reddin, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7318951523747618817/>, 01.06.2025)

Jan Tegze (Author, Full Stack Recruiter)

Tegze is right that buzzword-heavy copy-paste DMs are garbage. He's right that you should talk to people like humans. But his insistence that senders must "build social capital, community engagement, and brand presence before ever pitching" is operationally impractical for sales teams with monthly quotas. Building organic authority takes 6–12 months of sustained content creation. A SaaS sales team operating on quarterly targets will be out of business long before Tegze's social capital yields its first qualified meeting. Take his copy advice. Ignore his sequencing advice.

(Source: Jan Tegze, <https://jantegze.com/search/networking/>, 2026)

(Source: Jan Tegze, <https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7366749186375028743/>, 01.09.2025)

8. Source Index

Expert	LinkedIn URL	Most Relevant Post / Source
Peep Laja	https://www.linkedin.com/in/peeplaja/	https://exitfive.com/podcast/strategy-b2b-positioning-understanding-how-people-buy-and-building-wynter-peep-laja/
Andrew Gazdecki	https://www.linkedin.com/in/agazdecki/	https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7458867891807993856
Mac Reddin	https://www.linkedin.com/in/mac-reddin/	https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7270049384451502082/
Dave Gerhardt	https://www.linkedin.com/in/davegerhardt/	https://marketingexamples.com/sales/one-line-email
Amanda Natividad	https://www.linkedin.com/in/amandanat/	https://sparktoro.com/blog/shoot-your-shot-a-guide-to-effective-cold-outreach/
Melissa Grabiner	https://www.linkedin.com/in/melissa-grabiner/	https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7449875488371654656/
Hung Lee	https://www.linkedin.com/in/hunglee/	https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7426938549746442240/
Gergely Orosz	https://www.linkedin.com/in/gergelyoros/	https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7470132598581788672/
Jan Tegze	https://www.linkedin.com/in/jantegze/	https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:activity:7366749186375028743/
Adam Karpiak	https://www.linkedin.com/in/akarpiak/	https://www.linkedin.com/in/akarpiak/

Supplementary source: Reddit recipient-side findings — [research/other/reddit-findings.md](#)